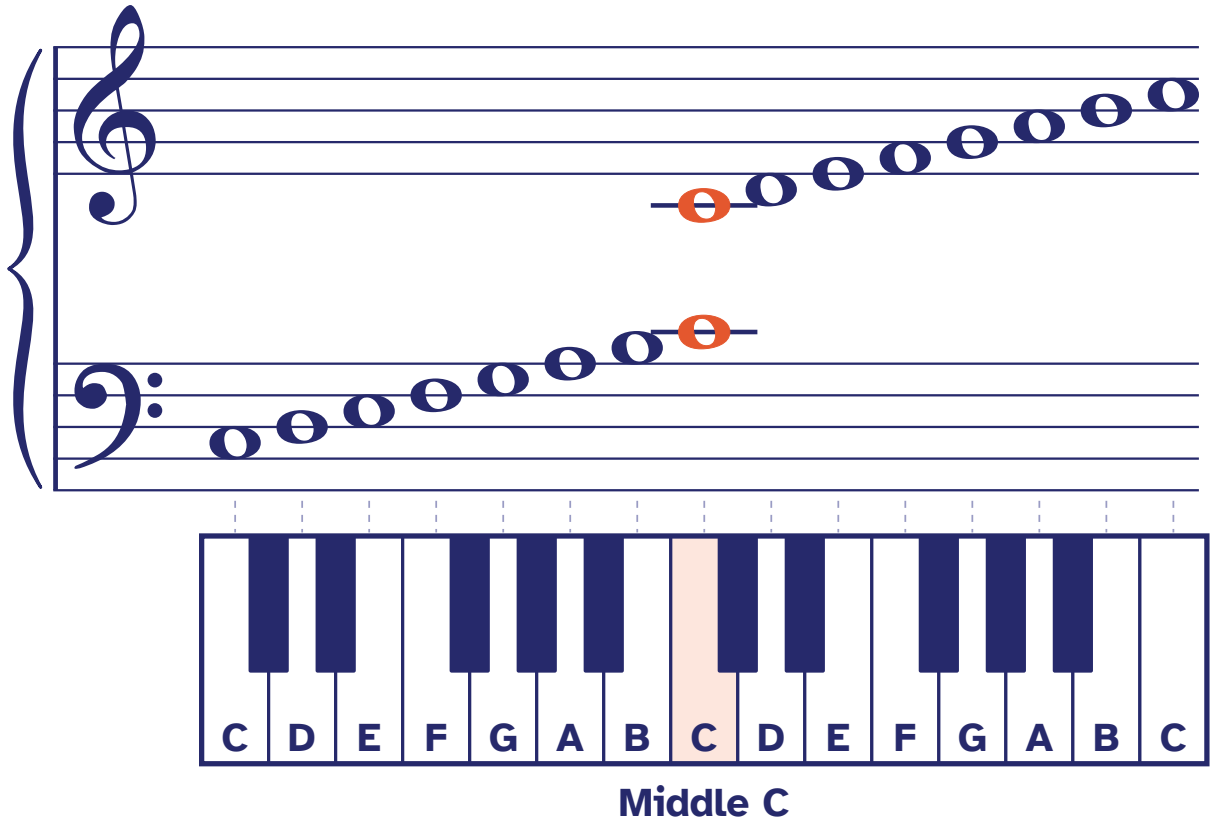
PART I · PITCH · 3

# The staff and the keyboard

Each line and each space of the grand staff is one white key. Climb the staff and you climb the keyboard: here are two octaves, from Bass C to Treble C, with Middle C in red where the two staves meet.

THE SECRET

**Every line and every space is one white key, in order.**




Between the two staves there is only one key: **Middle C**, written twice, below the treble staff or above the bass staff. No other key is missed out.

THE RULE

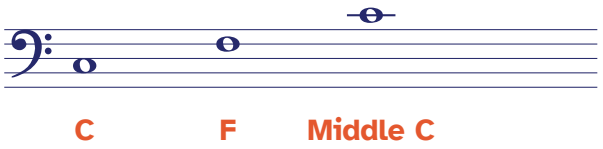
**One step on the staff (line to space, or space to line) is the very next white key. The black keys sit in between; how they are written is chapter 6 (p. 39).**

Up the staff is to the **right** on the keyboard; down the staff is to the **left**. A note on a line and the note in the space just above it are next-door white keys, so no key is ever missed out.

PART I · PITCH · 3 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

## From the page to the key

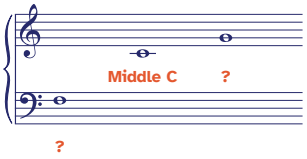



1. **Name the note:** line 4 of the bass staff, between the clef's dots, is F.
2. **On the piano,** find the three black keys just below Middle C.
3. **F is the first key** of that family: play it with the left hand.

The bass-clef F is the **F just below Middle C**: left of the three black keys under it.

EXAMPLE 2

## Mirror notes either side of Middle C

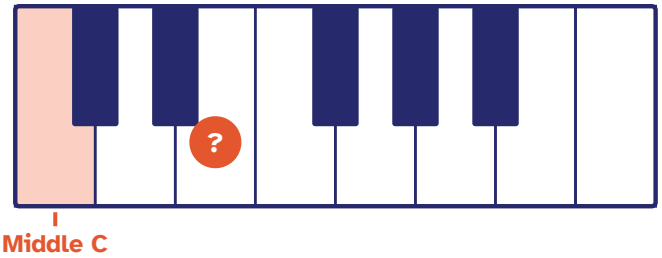



1. **Treble G:** the three black keys just above Middle C; G is the second key, after F.
2. **Bass F:** the three black keys just below Middle C; F is the first key.
3. **Now count each from Middle C:** C D E F G up, C B A G F down. Which number?

Both are **note 5**: mirror images. Fold the grand staff at Middle C and treble G lands exactly on bass F; the staves meet line for line.

EXAMPLE 3

## From the key to the page




1. **Find the ? key:** count up from Middle C, C 1, D 2 ...
2. **Do the same on the staff:** Middle C on its ledger line, D in the space under the staff ...
3. **Where do you land?**

The **?** is **E**, note 3, and it sits on the **bottom line** of the treble staff.

PART I · PITCH · 3 · CONTINUED

GAME

**Count the notes**

| 1 | 2 | 3 |
|---|---|---|
| Middle C up to A | Middle C down to E | G up to the next G |

Count the notes, both ends included. The staff climbs the same way: one line or space per note.

Answer: 1 six (C D E F G A) · 2 six (C B A G F E) · 3 eight: an octave.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS

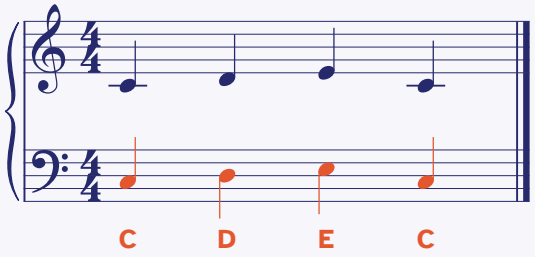



**Play Middle C, then walk up.**

Say each white key as you play it, C D E F G A B C, and picture each one climbing the staff: line, space, line, space.

YOU KNOW THIS

**Frère Jacques, in both hands**




The left hand plays the **same letters**, C D E C, one octave lower, written in the bass clef.

**Try it.** Play it right hand, then left hand, then both together.

THINK OF IT The staff is a ladder laid beside the keyboard: each rung, a line or a space, is the next white key.

TRAP

- × Skipping a key: every line and every space is used, one white key each.
- × Counting from 0: the note you start on is note 1.

SEE ALSO

The staff and the clefs p. 27 · Reading the notes p. 32

PRACTISE IT

Workbook Pitch 3 · Online: The Staff & the Two Clefs · Line and Space Names